

Transforming the world by changing from within

The world today is **grappling with profound** imbalances and divisions, **driven** by wars, climate change and natural disasters. We find ourselves **yearning for** a transformation in society, a shift that can **lead to** a more **harmonious, equitable** and **sustainable** world.

We can **aspire to** bring about such a shift by recognising the profound interconnectedness of life. Buddhist teachings beautifully **illustrate** this idea through the **parable** of Indra's net. **Indra**, who represents the power of nature, **is** said to be covered with a huge net **studded** with **innumerable** gems **sparkling** in many different colours. No single gem is at the centre of the net; each is equally the centre of the whole. Each gem **reflects** every other gem, making it shine brighter and creating a **magnificent** and perfectly harmonious **realm**. Similarly, when we recognise this interconnectedness, we realise that our actions, thoughts, and intentions **ripple** outward, impacting all of life around us.

This principle aligns deeply with teachings of my mentor, the third president of Soka Gakkai, Daisaku Ikeda. He often spoke of the concept of human revolution, which refers to the inner transformation of each individual as the source of **lasting** change. He famously said: "A great human **revolution** in just a single individual **will** help achieve a change in the destiny of a nation and, further, **will** enable a change in the destiny of all humankind."

In other words, if we aspire to change society – or even the world – that change must begin within ourselves.

The 'Lotus Sutra' teaches that every person has **inherent** Buddha nature, a **state** of pure awareness considered to be the ninth and deepest level of **consciousness**, which can be developed through practising its teachings. A **person** who has **undergone** a profound human revolution on the deepest level of consciousness **knows** how to relate to nature and other human beings. He knows that humanity must **strive to** remain in **harmony** with forces and cycles of nature.

Buddhism **expounds** on the principle of the **oneness** of life and its environment. This teaches that nature, and human beings are not in opposition; rather, they are **inseparably** linked and **intrinsically** interdependent. Our well-being is **intertwined** with the health of the environment, and understanding this connection is crucial to **fostering** a sustainable future.

Though we may take infinite measures to protect our environment, people and this Earth, the only way to **bring about** a permanent change in society is a revolution in the consciousness of both individuals and the world.

This journey of inner transformation brings an **immense** sense of hope. It's **empowering** to know that by continually working on one's own life, one can create **ripples** of positivity in the world. It's a reminder that **change**, no matter how small, **matters**. That inner change is an essential light we can all **spark** to make the world a brighter place for all.

[Practice Exercise]

Vocabulary

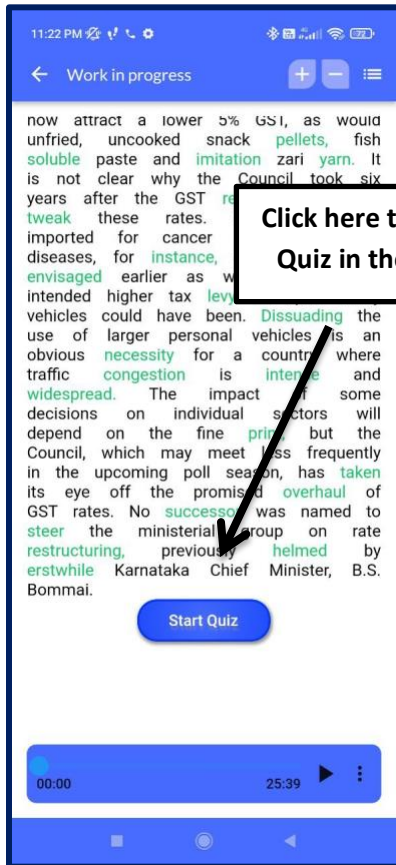
1. **Grapple with** (phrasal verb) – Struggle with, wrestle with, tackle, confront, deal with से जूझना
2. **Profound** (adjective) – Deep, intense, significant, insightful, far-reaching गहन
3. **Drive** (verb) – Propel, motivate, push, compel, urge प्रेरित करना
4. **Yearn for** (verb) – Long for, desire, crave, aspire to, hanker after तरसना
5. **Lead to** (verb) – Result in, cause, bring about, give rise to, produce की ओर ले जाना
6. **Harmonious** (adjective) – Balanced, peaceful, concordant, compatible, in harmony सामंजस्यपूर्ण
7. **Equitable** (adjective) – Fair, just, impartial, unbiased, even-handed न्यायसंगत
8. **Sustainable** (adjective) – Environmentally friendly, maintainable, viable, enduring, long-lasting सतत
9. **Aspire to** (verb) – Aim for, strive for, desire, seek, hope to achieve आकांक्षा करना
10. **Illustrate** (verb) – Explain, demonstrate, exemplify, depict, show व्याख्या करना
11. **Parable** (noun) – Moral story, allegory, fable, tale, teaching story शिक्षाप्रद कथा
12. **Stud** (verb) – Adorn, decorate, embellish, dot, sprinkle सजाना
13. **Innumerable** (adjective) – Countless, numerous, myriad, innumerable, countless असंख्य
14. **Sparkle** (verb) – Shine, glitter, twinkle, gleam, glisten चमकना
15. **Reflect** (verb) – Mirror, show, indicate, embody, manifest दिखाना
16. **Magnificent** (adjective) – Grand, splendid, majestic, glorious, superb भव्य
17. **Realm** (noun) – Domain, sphere, world, area, field क्षेत्र
18. **Ripple** (verb) – Spread, undulate, flow outward, radiate, move in waves लहराना
19. **Lasting** (adjective) – Enduring, permanent, long-term, durable, persistent स्थायी
20. **Inherent** (adjective) – Innate, intrinsic, natural, built-in, essential अंतर्निहित
21. **State** (noun) – Condition, situation, status, phase, mode स्थिति
22. **Consciousness** (noun) – Awareness, mindfulness, perception, cognizance, alertness चेतना

23. **Undergo** (verb) – Experience, go through, endure, pass through, be subjected to से गुजरना
24. **Strive to** (verb) – Endeavor, attempt, try hard, aim, work towards प्रयास करना
25. **Harmony** (noun) – Peace, accord, unity, concord, balance सामंजस्य
26. **Expound** (verb) – Explain, elucidate, interpret, set forth, clarify विस्तार से समझाना
27. **Oneness** (noun) – Unity, wholeness, sameness, singularity, union एकता
28. **Inseparably** (adverb) – Indivisibly, indistinguishably, indissolubly, inextricably अविभाज्य रूप से
29. **Intrinsically** (adverb) – Essentially, inherently, fundamentally, by nature, innately स्वाभाविक रूप से
30. **Intertwined** (adjective) – Interconnected, interwoven, linked, entwined, entangled परस्पर जुड़े हुए
31. **Foster** (verb) – Promote, encourage, nurture, cultivate, support प्रोत्साहित करना
32. **Bring about** (phrasal verb) – Cause, produce, lead to, result in, effect कारण बनना
33. **Immense** (adjective) – Huge, vast, enormous, great, colossal विशाल
34. **Empowering** (adjective) – Enabling, authorizing, equipping, strengthening, giving power सशक्त करने वाला
35. **Ripple** (noun) – Wave, undulation, vibration, movement, spread लहर
36. **Spark** (verb) – Initiate, trigger, kindle, ignite, stimulate प्रेरित करना

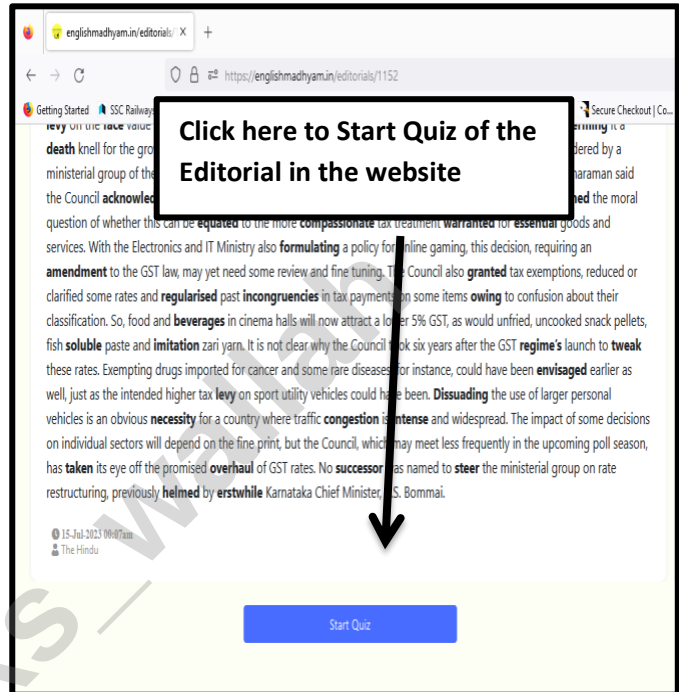
Summary of the Editorial

1. The world today faces immense challenges, including wars, climate change, and natural disasters, leading to a strong desire for societal transformation.
2. Achieving a harmonious, equitable, and sustainable world requires acknowledging the interconnectedness of all life forms.
3. Buddhist teachings, like the parable of Indra's net, illustrate the concept of interconnectedness, where each element influences and reflects the entire system.
4. Indra's net symbolizes the interconnected nature of our existence, where our actions, thoughts, and intentions impact the world around us.
5. The teachings of Daisaku Ikeda, the third president of Soka Gakkai, emphasize that lasting change begins with individual transformation, known as human revolution.
6. Ikeda believed that a single individual's inner transformation could lead to widespread societal and global change.
7. Personal change is crucial to achieving broader societal shifts; transformation must start from within to influence the external world.
8. The 'Lotus Sutra' explains the concept of Buddha nature, a state of pure awareness and the deepest level of consciousness inherent in all individuals.
9. Developing Buddha nature allows individuals to understand and respect the balance between humanity and nature.
10. Buddhism emphasizes the principle of the oneness of life and its environment, highlighting the inseparable link between humans and nature.
11. The well-being of humans and the health of the environment are intrinsically connected, emphasizing the need for mutual respect and understanding.
12. Permanent societal change can only be achieved through a revolution in consciousness on both individual and global levels.
13. This inner transformation instills hope, empowering people to create positive change in the world by working on themselves.
14. Every small act of inner change has a ripple effect, contributing to a more positive and harmonious global community.
15. The idea is that inner change serves as a crucial and impactful force to illuminate the world, making it a better place for everyone.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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